

SCRIBES

Software Requirements Specification

Version 2.0 · Revised Edition
Prepared: May 01, 2026

Version	Date	Summary
1.0	2025 (prior)	Original SRS
2.0	2026-05-01	Resolved immutability tension, taxonomy governance, ranking/analytics conflict, DM moderation

1. Product Overview

Scribes is a knowledge publishing and preservation platform designed for believers to compose, preserve, and share personalized spiritual insights. The system treats published content as durable knowledge artifacts — traceable, author-attributed, and structurally resistant to silent revision.

2. Core Principles & Constraints

These principles reflect the product's philosophical posture in v1. They are intentional scope decisions, not permanent identity claims — and should be revisited as the product evolves.

Authenticity

Teachings must remain attributed and preserved exactly as the author intended at time of publication.

Traceability

All published content links back to its original author. If an author deletes their account, the content is retained but the handle converts to an anonymous placeholder.

Auditable Content History

Rather than strict immutability, Scribes employs versioned transparency. Authors may publish a formal Revision to an existing Post. All prior versions remain permanently accessible in a Version History panel — nothing is silently erased.

No In-Product AI (v1 Scope Exclusion)

AI-powered features are explicitly out of scope for v1. This is a scoping decision, not a platform identity constraint. It will be reassessed in future versions.

Design Note: The original SRS stated 'No In-Product AI' as a core principle. This has been reclassified as a v1 scope exclusion to avoid permanently constraining future product direction.

3. Client Architecture & Delivery

- Ecosystem: Multi-client, ubiquitous architecture.
- Clients: Web Application (desktop drafting/reading) and Mobile Application (portable reading, offline capture).
- Backend: Both clients interface with a single unified backend API.

4. Core Domain Model

Notes

Private writing workspaces. Fully editable. Used for drafting ideas and sermons.

Post Drafts

A distinct, temporary queue for unpublished text initiated via Direct Post Creation, preventing Note workspace clutter.

Posts

Published knowledge artifacts containing content, captions, hashtags, structured scripture references, and an optional sermon source. Posts are durable and author-attributed.

Post Versions

When an author publishes a Revision, a new version snapshot is created. The Post always displays the latest version by default. All prior versions are accessible via a Version History panel (see §5).

Correction Posts

Retained for substantive theological corrections where the author intentionally wants the original to stand alongside the correction — e.g., a doctrinal clarification. A Correction Post links to the original via an appended erratum footnote.

5. Content Creation & Versioning

5.1 Rich Text Editor

A WYSIWYG editor supporting bold, italics, headings, bulleted lists, and blockquotes.

5.2 Media

No native media hosting (images, audio, video). External media is supported exclusively via URL attributes parsed into rich-link preview cards.

5.3 Taxonomy & Governance

Authors must select from a pre-defined list of domain-specific categories when publishing. Scripture tags use a structured database selector (Book, Chapter, Verse).

Design Note: The original SRS referenced a pre-defined category list without specifying ownership. This created a governance gap.

Resolution: The Super Admin role owns the canonical taxonomy list. Admins may add, deprecate, or merge categories via the internal dashboard. Authors cannot propose new categories directly in v1 — this is deferred to a future community governance model. Deprecated categories remain attached to existing Posts for historical accuracy.

5.4 Versioned Posts

This mechanism replaces strict immutability for content corrections that do not warrant a separate Correction Post (e.g., typos, factual errors where the author does not want two competing artifacts to exist).

Scenario	Mechanism	Old version accessible?
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Typo / minor wording fix	Publish Revision	Yes — Version History panel
Doctrinal correction where original must stand	Correction Post	Yes — erratum footnote on original
Author retracts post entirely	Soft-delete (author-visible only; public sees nothing)	Yes — public sees nothing

5.5 Offline Drafting

The application uses a local-first architecture. Users can draft Notes and read cached Posts completely offline. Local changes silently sync to the cloud upon reconnection.

6. Workspace Organisation & Curation

- Private Notes: Organised using a single-level List/Notebook model (analogous to Google Tasks).
- Saved Content: Two strictly private, chronological lists — Bookmarks (lightweight references) and Imports (read-only copied text).

7. Interaction & Community

7.1 Comments

- Architecture: Single-level, flat comment stream beneath a Post.
- @mentions facilitate user-to-user dialogue.
- Visibility: Open by default. Post author acts as moderator — can hide or delete individual comments.

7.2 Reactions

- Domain-specific reactions (e.g., "Insightful", "Amen") instead of generic likes.
- Public views show aggregate counts. Authors see identical counts plus specific reactor identities.

7.3 Direct Messaging

- Mutual-only DMs. Users must approve a Message Request from non-mutuals before conversations begin.

Design Note: The original SRS defined the DM connection model but omitted message content rules, retention policy, and moderation scope — a significant gap before implementation.

Resolution: v1 DM scope: text-only messages, no media attachments. Message history is retained for 12 months from last activity, then purged. Users can delete their own messages (soft-delete: replaced with 'Message deleted'). Either party can block a conversation, which prevents further messages and hides the thread. Moderation: DMs are not proactively reviewed. Users can report a conversation; a Super Admin may access reported threads only under the reported-content review workflow.

8. Discovery & Visibility

8.1 Primary Feed

A curated feed surfacing Posts exclusively from followed authors, in reverse-chronological order.

8.2 Explore Space

A secondary discovery area for trending, categorised, or newly published public Posts from the wider community.

8.3 Cold Start (Onboarding)

New users select topics of interest during signup. The primary feed temporarily populates with public Posts matching these categories until the user follows specific authors.

Design Note: The original SRS stated the cold-start feed shows 'highly rated' Posts, implying a rating/ranking system — but §10 (Analytics) explicitly excluded hidden metrics like view counts. This was a direct contradiction.

Resolution: Cold-start Posts are selected by deliberate interaction score only: a weighted sum of Reaction count and Comment count on Posts within the selected categories, within a rolling 90-day window. No view counts, read times, or implicit signals are used. This is consistent with the minimalist analytics policy and does not introduce hidden tracking.

8.4 Orphaned Posts

If a user deletes their account, their published public Posts remain active to preserve the knowledge base. The author's handle on these Posts permanently converts to an anonymous placeholder (e.g., [Deleted User]).

8.5 Correction Visibility

Correction Posts are linked to the Original Post via a contextual erratum footnote appended to the bottom of the original artifact.

9. Account & Identity Management

- Authentication: Traditional Email and Password. No mandatory third-party SSO.
- Author Identity: Pseudonymous handle-based system (unique @username and customisable display name).
- Connection Model: Quiet Asymmetric Following — users can follow anyone without approval. Follower counts and lists are strictly private to the author.
- Roles: Flat hierarchy — Standard Users (community members) and Super Admins (internal staff).

10. Platform Ecosystem

10.1 Moderation

Standard user reporting system. Content remains active until manually reviewed and actioned by a Super Admin via an internal backend dashboard.

10.2 Notifications

Batched/digest notifications for standard interactions delivered at scheduled intervals. Immediate real-time alerts reserved for high-priority events (@mentions, admin alerts).

10.3 Exporting

Users can export a Post as a standalone Markdown (.md) or Plain Text (.txt) file, preserving visual formatting, author handle, dates, version number, and a deep link back to Scribes.

10.4 Analytics

Minimalist author analytics tracking only deliberate interactions: Reactions and Comments. No hidden metrics (unique views, read times, scroll depth) are tracked or stored.

Consistency guarantee: The cold-start ranking algorithm (§8.3) uses only these same deliberate interaction metrics. No shadow metrics are introduced at any layer of the system.

10.5 Public Profiles

Barebones chronological feeds displaying the author's Display Name, Handle, Bio, and published public Posts.

11. Technology Stack

Backend API

Go (Golang) — standard net/http library for routing; Goroutines for background batch processing.

Primary Database

PostgreSQL (JSONB for rich text payload storage), accessed via sqlc for type-safe queries.

Client Framework

Flutter (Dart) — compiled to native iOS/Android for mobile; WebAssembly (Wasm) for web.

State & Storage

Riverpod for state management; Drift (SQLite) for local-first offline drafting architecture.

Synchronisation

Custom REST HTTP endpoints with timestamp-based delta sync (`last_synced_at`).

Containerisation

Docker (multi-stage builds for Go backend).

Design Note: Timestamp-based delta sync (`last_synced_at`) is vulnerable to clock skew across devices, which can cause missed or duplicated sync events.

Resolution: The sync strategy must use server-assigned logical timestamps (monotonic sequence numbers or server-side `updated_at` set by the database, never the client clock). The client sends its last known `server_sequence` value; the server returns all records with a higher sequence. Client clocks are never trusted for ordering.

12. Open Items & Deferred Decisions

The following items are explicitly deferred and must be addressed before v2 planning begins:

Community Taxonomy Governance

v1 gives Super Admins full taxonomy ownership. A community-proposal model (author-suggested categories, admin approval) is deferred to v2.

AI-Powered Features

Out of scope for v1. Candidates for v2 include: semantic search over the Post corpus, scripture auto-tagging suggestions, and personalised Explore recommendations. Each will require a separate privacy and ethics review before adoption.

Version Conflict Resolution

If an author edits a Post while offline and a concurrent online revision exists, the conflict resolution strategy is undefined. Deferred to v2 with a last-write-wins default in v1 (server timestamp authoritative).

Media Hosting

Native image/audio/video hosting is out of scope for v1. External URL preview cards are the only supported mechanism.